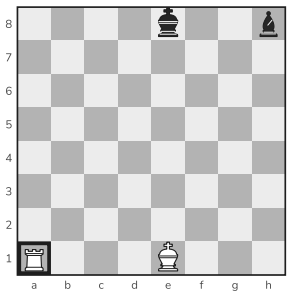
Five rules to agree before you play

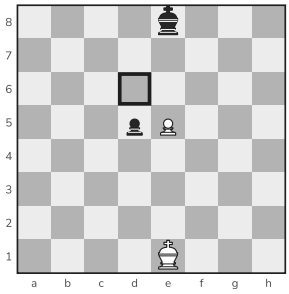
The official rule for each, as the FIDE Laws of Chess put it. Fold the card in half and keep it by the board; the back is for your family's own rules.



1 Castling

You can't castle out of, through or into check. Your rook can be attacked, and it can even cross an attacked square.

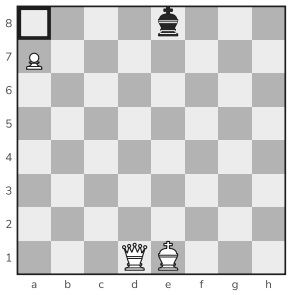
FIDE Laws of Chess, article 3.8.2



2 En passant

A pawn that jumps two squares past yours can be taken as if it moved one, but only on the very next move.

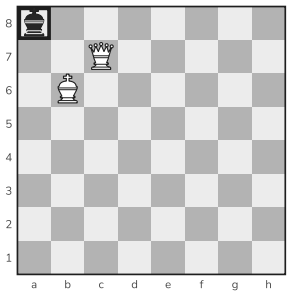
FIDE Laws of Chess, article 3.7.3.2



3 Promotion

A pawn on the far side becomes a queen, rook, bishop or knight. It doesn't have to be a piece you've lost: two queens are fine.

FIDE Laws of Chess, articles 3.7.3.3 to 3.7.3.4



4 Stalemate

No legal move and not in check is a draw, not a win.

FIDE Laws of Chess, article 5.2.1



5 Touch-move

In a tournament, a piece you touch must move. Say "I adjust" to straighten one. At home, agree it before you start.

FIDE Laws of Chess, articles 4.2.1 and 4.3

More in RankUp Chess, an offline chess app for children. Its free lessons teach castling, en passant, promotion and stalemate.
stillwareltd.com/rankupchess

Rules: FIDE Laws of Chess, in force from 1 January 2023.

Our family's rules

Tick how you play each one. A house rule is fine at home, as long as everyone agrees it before the game.

Rule	We play it	We skip it (house rule)
1 **Castling**	☐	☐
2 **En passant**	☐	☐
3 **Promotion**	☐	☐
4 **Stalemate**	☐	☐
5 **Touch-move**	☐	☐

Agreed on _____ by _____ and _____

Any other house rule

More in RankUp Chess, an offline chess app for children. Its free lessons teach castling, en passant, promotion and stalemate.
stillwareltd.com/rankupchess
Rules: FIDE Laws of Chess, in force from 1 January 2023.